



1/2 pg V Ad

small company as an effective marketing tool. "A CD should be created from the long term business point of view. Unlike music or films, the success of a CD cannot be just determined by sales alone; people buy the CD and may even take years to buy my work; this is just a step towards making my work known to people."

The initial reaction to Mehrotra's CD was that of fascination, since nothing of this sort existed in the art world before. "But now I see a change," he says, "Several colleagues of mine are now going digital." There is a sense of accomplishment in his eyes when he says this, even if some of the purists have not accepted this form of building awareness.

Technology And Art: Do The Twain Meet?

Mehrotra defends digital art not with the irrational fanaticism of a blind supporter, but with the reasoned rationale of a seasoned parliamentarian: "Digital art is equally creative. There is a misconception that digital art is dependent only on the computer's capabilities. This is simply not true. Unless you give the necessary commands to the machine, and incorporate your ideas, how in the world is the computer going to create art?"

"Technology has ensured that art sites have mushroomed; one is now able to look at pieces of work that were not accessible earlier. It has brought art to the common man. Earlier, making a film was considered a multi-layered process; today one can shoot on a personal video camera, and edit pictures at home on a personal computer."

Even as art dealers and artists try to get comfortable about the use of technology, Mehrotra has only shown the way. He says the day is not far when the world's first digital painting with a digital signature of a prominent artist would go on sale for half a million dollars. "This will make people notice digital art," he believes.

Meanwhile, at Crossword, a nationwide chain of bookstores, Mehrotra's CD sells as the sole representative of a CD-ROM on art. For now, he can be happy that he still remains the only Indian artist to have dabbled in this medium. It won't be long before he has followers. ☐

aparna_krishnakumar@thinkdigit.com